



YİĞİT ÖZEN

THIRTY-FIVE WORKS

Paintings since 2019

ISTANBUL · MILAN · LUXEMBOURG

YIGITOZEN.XYZ

Thirty-five paintings

2019–2026 · ISTANBUL, MILAN AND LUXEMBOURG

Eight of thirty-five works made since 2019 across Istanbul, Milan and Luxembourg. The whole book, with every detail and the stages of the newest paintings, is at yigitozen.xyz/artbook.

MEDIUM

ACRYLIC ON CANVAS, ON CARTON AND ON PAPER,
AND ONE DRAWING IN CHARCOAL

ORDER

NEWEST FIRST, SO THE SEVEN YEARS ARE READ
BACKWARDS

RIGHTS

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Paintings since 2019

01

7 fam board game

ACRYLIC ON CANVAS · 100 × 80 CM · 39 ¾ × 31 ½ IN · 2026 · LUXEMBOURG

One side stands wrapped, each cone clear of the next; the other is stacked two and three high until one head cannot be told from another. Those are the two ways of being a family available on this board, and the game is between them. Nothing has been taken off, so whatever is being played is not the kind of game that ends with a winner. The larger of the two heads has neither eyes nor a mouth; the small one opposite it is all glare.

COLOUR — WARM AND COOL LEVEL AT ABOUT A THIRD EACH, CYAN THE LARGEST FAMILY, GREEN UNDER TWO IN A THOUSAND
COMPOSITION — A BOARD TURNED CORNER ON, ITS NEAR POINT THE ONE CORNER SHOWN WHOLE, TWO HEADS AT OPPOSITE SCALES
HAND — LOBES TURNED WET INTO WET FOR THE HEADS, THE WRAPPINGS AND THE FACES DRAWN LAST WITH A THIN TIP



02

Virgil on Virtual Cage (final_final-finalV9)

ACRYLIC ON CANVAS · 80 x 100 CM · 31 ½ x 39 ⅝ IN · 2026 · LUXEMBOURG

The cage is drawn, not built. A few white lines lay a ceiling across the top and drop two uprights, then stop two fifths of the way down, so nothing is actually shut in. Underneath, the bodies are soft, pressed from the tube and scratched while still wet, and not one of them looks at the lines. The title carries a guide out of the underworld and a file name that has been saved as final nine times over: two promises of an ending, made by something that has none.

COLOUR — THREE QUARTERS WARM, COOL UNDER FOUR PER CENT, THE WHITE WIG THE LIGHTEST POINT

COMPOSITION — A WHITE LINED BOX THAT PROMISES TO ENCLOSE AND STOPS AT TWO FIFTHS OF THE HEIGHT

HAND — GRAINY PINK PRESSED FROM THE TUBE AND SCRATCHED WHILE WET, AGAINST FLAT OPAQUE LINE



articulo attack on mandarin

ACRYLIC ON CANVAS · 80 × 80 CM · 31 ½ × 31 ½ IN · 2026 · LUXEMBOURG

The flock is already committed, every wing swept the same way down the diagonal, and the row of figures standing along the boat does not look up. Each of them has an X where the eyes should be, so there is nobody aboard to see it coming. The anchor lies in the corner with its chain beside it. One thin figure at the centre holds the pole, which is the only act in the painting, and it cannot be told whether it is steering or holding on.

COLOUR — BLUE, GREY, WHITE AND BLACK ONLY, CONTRAST CARRIED BY VALUE AND NOT BY HUE

COMPOSITION — A FLOCK ON THE MAIN DIAGONAL, UPPER RIGHT TO LOWER LEFT, OVER A ROW OF FIGURES A THIRD UP

HAND — A LOADED BRUSH FLUNG SIDEWAYS, BRISTLES SPLITTING, NO WING ENTERED TWICE



ciao capo, sono squalo

ACRYLIC ON CANVAS · 65 × 90 CM · 25 5/8 × 35 3/8 IN · 2020 · MILAN

The pointed teeth ranged in the open mouth of the figure on the left stand as the one sharp edge within the softness of the rest of the painting. The title gives this mouth a sentence: hello boss, I am the shark. An Italian and overly cheerful greeting, the opening line of someone introducing himself as a predator.

COLOUR — FIVE NAMES ONLY, AND BLUE OCCURS IN THE BODIES ALONE AND CARRIES THE WHOLE DIVISION

COMPOSITION — TWO VERTICAL MASSES SHARING THE FRAME, THREE FEET AT THE LEFT AND TWO AT THE RIGHT

HAND — ONE TURNING PULL PER EGG UNIT, NEVER ENTERED TWICE, OVER A NEAR DRY COMBED WALL



viperella

ACRYLIC ON CANVAS · 50 × 70 CM · 19 ¾ × 27 ½ IN · 2020 · MILAN

A dark band closes in from all four sides and leaves within it a light green rectangle between lemon and pistachio, setting up a second frame inside the painting. The figure is placed right in the middle of that bright field, standing in profile.

COLOUR — A LIGHT INNER FIELD AGAINST A DARK OUTER BELT, THE BODY ITSELF IN NO COLOUR FAMILY

COMPOSITION — A SECOND FRAME PAINTED INSIDE THE PICTURE WITH THE FIGURE AT ITS MIDDLE

HAND — THIN HORIZONTAL GROUND LETTING THE WEAVE SHOW, LOADED CURVES FOR THE MASSES, DARK STROKES LAST



victim psycho-logique II : the peachy pharaoh connects with the chair

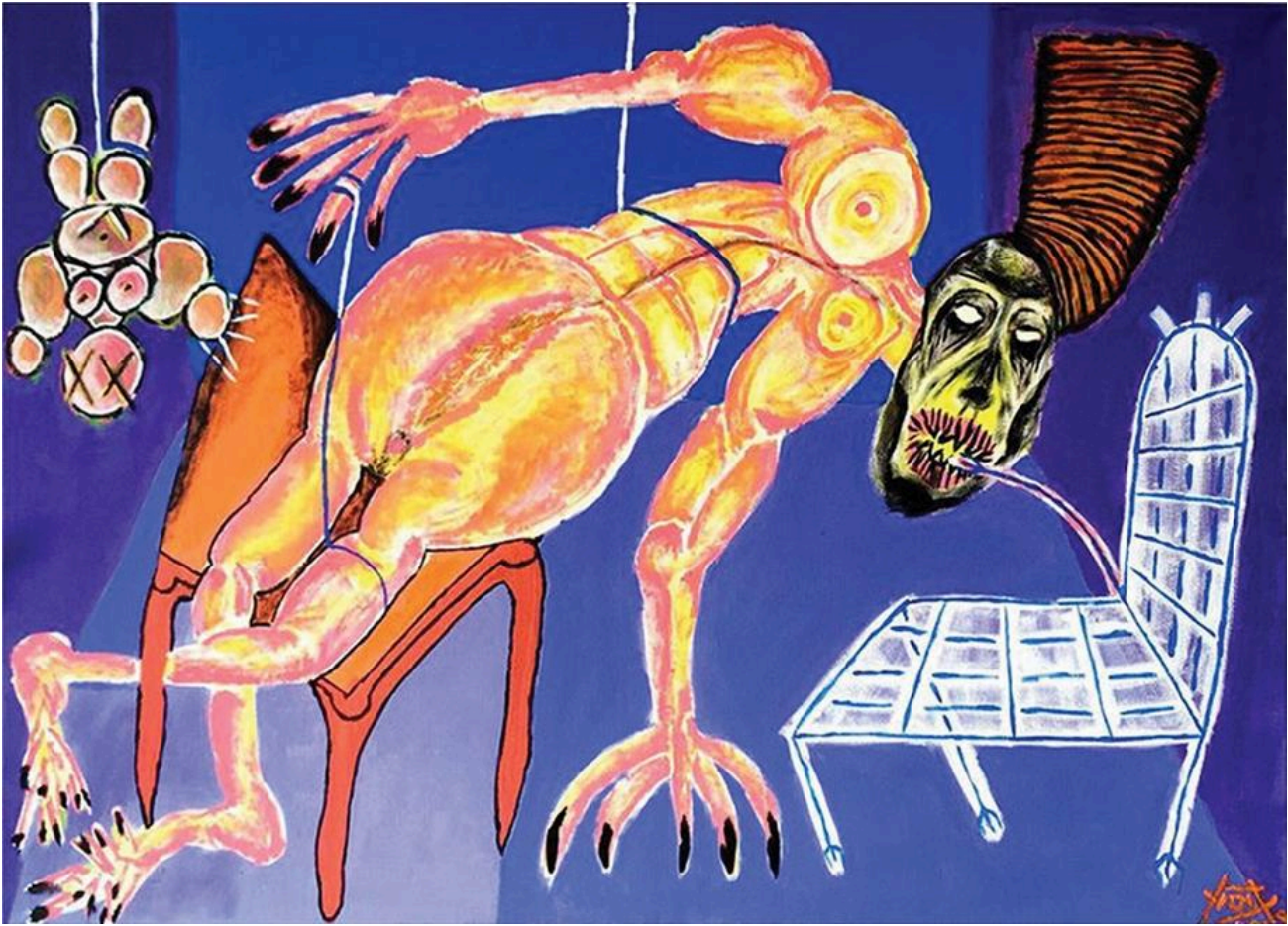
ACRYLIC ON CANVAS · 65 × 90 CM · 25 5/8 × 35 3/8 IN · 2019 · MILAN

A peach-coloured body stands doubled over on a diagonal running from lower left to upper right, its heaviest mass gathered right at the level of the belly, the legs that bear it thin and long; the borne is heavy, the bearer weak.

COLOUR — HALF A SINGLE BLUE PURPLE AGAINST THE PEACH YELLOW BODY, OPPOSITE ENDS OF THE WHEEL

COMPOSITION — THREE UNITS LEFT TO RIGHT, A HANGING TOY, A BODY COLLAPSED ON A CHAIR, AN EMPTY CHAIR IN LINE

HAND — FLAT GROUND IN ONE COAT, THE BODY RUBBED SOFT INSIDE A THICK BLACK CONTOUR, ONE CHAIR UNPAINTED



remixed execution of lucid drowning

ACRYLIC ON CANVAS · 65 × 90 CM · 25 ⅝ × 35 ⅝ IN · 2019 · MILAN

A greenish body is spread horizontally and no border is drawn between it and the blue beneath; where the body ends and where the water begins is unclear. The arms are open, the legs hang, no trace of resistance. Whether it is sinking or swimming, the painting does not say.

COLOUR — GREEN LEVEL WITH BLUE, WARM UNDER A TENTH AND HELD TO THE FLOWER CLUSTERS

COMPOSITION — A GREEN MASS ACROSS THE HORIZONTAL THAT NEVER CLOSES INTO A SILHOUETTE

HAND — THREE TEMPOS AT ONCE, A DRY SCRUBBED GROUND, A WET SOFT BODY, A JAGGED DRY COLUMN



two woman figures sitting at the back of the canvas

CHARCOAL ON THE REVERSE OF CANVAS · 65 x 90 CM · 25 5/8 x 35 3/8 IN · 2019 · MILAN

The stretcher bars and the central rail are visible just as they are; two female figures are drawn in charcoal on the unpainted back face of the canvas, that is the side normally left turned to the wall.

COLOUR — NO PAINT AT ALL, THE RANGE RUNNING BETWEEN CHARCOAL BLACK AND RAW CLOTH WHITE

COMPOSITION — THE STRETCHER CROSSBAR DIVIDING THE BACK INTO TWO EQUAL PANELS, ONE FIGURE IN EACH

HAND — CHARCOAL ON UNPRIMED CLOTH, HOLDING TO THE CRESTS OF THE WEAVE WITH NO BINDER



The face

THE ONE SQUARE METRE THAT IS FOUGHT OVER

Everything the paintings will not settle is settled, or refused, on the face. One head is worked until it has neither eyes nor mouth while the head opposite it is nothing but glare. One neck carries two faces at once, one a skull and one asleep. A band of red is laid across the eyes. In one painting the head is a lumpy tip with no face set on it at all.

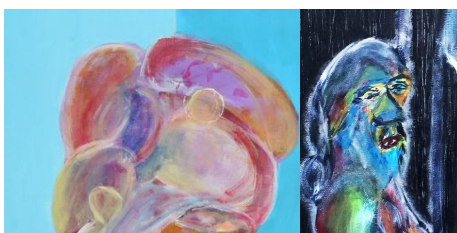
The face is the battlefield of identity: the place where the painting decides whether there is a person here, and often declines to decide. The bodies are assembled out of parts and can be rebuilt; the face is where that becomes a question about somebody rather than about construction.

18 · 2019 — NO FACE SET UPON IT AT ALL





32 · 2019 — A FACE TAKING HALF THE PICTURE, DRAWN OVER ITSELF · FACING IT, 18 · 2019 — NO FACE SET UPON IT AT ALL

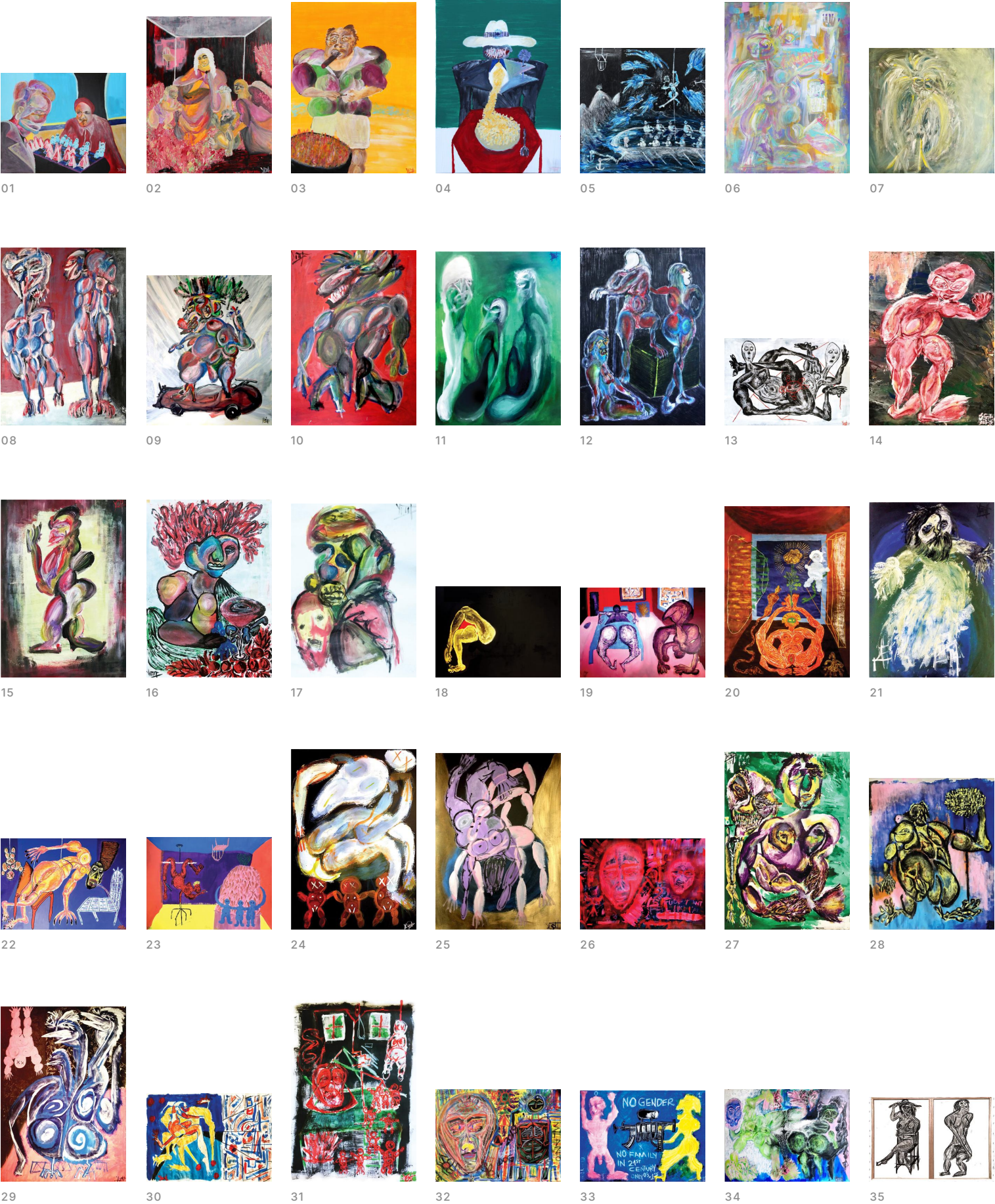


01 AGAINST 12



21 AGAINST 27

THE FACE IS WHERE THE PAINTING DECIDES WHETHER THERE IS A PERSON HERE, AND OFTEN DECLINES TO DECIDE



EVERY PLATE AT ONE WIDTH, IN THE ORDER OF THE BOOK

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